

You can consolidate all your loans with one lender at any time without a consolidation loan if you just want to simplify your payments. If a lower interest rate is your goal, remember that after making forty-eight consecutive on-time payments, you may qualify for an interest-rate reduction. This may put you at a lower rate than you could get by consolidating, depending on your current interest rate. To figure out what makes the most sense for you, try Sallie Mae's online loan consolidation calculator in the tools and calculators section at www.salliemae.com.